Edward marched to the strategic port of Calais and laid siege to it. The defenders held out for eleven months; Philip, hoping to lift the attack by distracting his enemy, sent word to David II of Scotland asking him to invade England from the north. The plan was a disaster. David led the Scottish army towards Durham only to encounter, unexpectedly, an English force hastily assembled by the Archbishop of York. Once again, the English archers broke the Scottish line: "Few Englishmen were killed," says the *Chronicle of Lanercost*, "but nearly the whole of the army of Scotland was either captured or slain." David himself was taken prisoner back to London, where he would remain for the next eleven years.[15]

Louis IV's reluctance to send the promised soldiers to Edward had been followed up by overtures to the French king, and then by a complicated series of conflicts with his nobles over deaths and marriage alliances. By 1346, he had few friends left; and the German electors exercised the power that Louis had helped them gain by electing a new king, Charles of Bohemia, to replace him.

Louis IV, now sixty-two, refused to recognize the election. Just as civil war seemed inevitable, he had a stroke during a bear hunt and fell dead from his horse.[16]

Philip VI lost Calais. The defenders finally surrendered in August of 1347; Edward III immediately established an English colony there, ordering thirty-six well-established English families to settle in the city, along with three hundred "men of lesser standing" and encouraging the French exodus: "I wish to repopulate Calais with pure-blooded English," he announced.[17]

And then, just as he was poised to take advantage of his victories, the world ended.